



Business License Application Checklist

Your Roadmap to Launching a Business in Irvine

This guide is your shortcut to a successful application. By following these steps in order, you'll avoid common delays, protect your investment, and get your doors open faster.

1. Confirm Your Perfect Location

Before you sign a lease or commit to a space, let's make sure it's a match for your vision. Most application delays happen because the business activity doesn't match the property's zoning.

- ☐ **The "Zoning First" Check:** Contact our Planning Team at 949-724-6308 or planning@cityofirvine.org. They will confirm if your business is "good to go" at your chosen address.
- ☐ **Home-Based Success:** If you're starting a business from home, ensure you meet the City's [Home Occupation Standards](#) to stay in harmony with your neighborhood.

2. Create Your Digital Toolkit

- ☐ **Professional Credentials:** If your trade requires a State of California license (contractor, cosmetologist, etc.), have a digital copy (PDF or photo) ready to upload. **[Required]**
- ☐ **Tax & Identity:** Have your Federal Employer Identification Number (EIN) ready. *This keeps your Social Security number private.*
- ☐ **Non-Profit Advantage:** If you are a 501(c)(3), have your IRS Determination Letter ready to unlock fee waivers. **[Required, if a non-profit]**

3. Connect with Industry Partners

Irvine businesses thrive when they are connected. Ensure you have these external essentials in order:

- ☐ **Seller's Permit:** If you sell physical items, have your permit number from the CDTFA.
- ☐ **Health & Alcohol:** Ensure your OC Health or ABC permits are ready if you're in food or beverage service.
- ☐ **The "DBA":** If your business name is different from your own, ensure it's registered with the OC Clerk-Recorder.

4. Finalize & Celebrate

- ☐ **Apply Online:** Complete the [Online Business License Application](#) and submit with confidence.
- ☐ **Show It Off:** Once approved, your license is valid for one year. Display it proudly – it shows your customers you are a verified member of the City of Irvine business community!

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Beyond the License: The Irvine Advantage

Once your license is in hand, your journey with the City is just beginning. Every Irvine-based business gains a competitive edge through our **5% Local Vendor Preference**, giving you a head start when bidding on City contracts for goods and services. Our Economic Development Department is excited to be your long-term partner, offering resources for site selection, networking, and navigating the local economy to protect your investment and help grow your business.

Specialized Support for Innovation

For businesses with complex or technical facility needs—specifically those in **Health Care Innovation & MedTech, Next-Gen Defense, Enabling & Creative Technologies, and Clean Energy & Sustainability**—we offer additional assistance.

Our [Irvine Navigator Program](#) provides a dedicated concierge to help you navigate the specialized licensing and permitting requirements unique to your industry.

- **Strategic Resources:** [Economic Development Portal](#)
- **Direct Line to Growth:** 949-724-6298 or economicdevelopment@cityofirvine.org

We're Here to Help

If you hit a snag or have a unique question, our Project Specialists are always here to help.

- **Call:** 949-724-7128 or **email:** businesslicense@cityofirvine.org
- **In Person:** Visit the Community Development Assistance Center at City Hall
 - **Hours:** Monday through Friday, 8 a.m. – 5 p.m. (Closed 12–1 p.m.)